

PHISHING EMAIL DETECTION & AWARENESS REPORT

Cyber Security Internship – Future Interns

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Task: Task 02 – Phishing Email Detection & Awareness

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Executive Summary

This report presents the results of a phishing email detection and awareness assessment conducted during the Cyber Security Internship program. The task focused on identifying phishing indicators, understanding social engineering techniques, and improving practical cybersecurity awareness regarding suspicious emails and online fraud.

A total of four phishing email samples and one legitimate email were analyzed during the assessment. Multiple phishing indicators such as fake domains, suspicious URLs, urgency tactics, and deceptive reward schemes were identified.

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1. Introduction

Phishing is a cyberattack technique in which attackers impersonate trusted organizations or individuals to steal sensitive information such as passwords, banking details, and personal information.

Phishing attacks commonly use fake emails, deceptive websites, and social engineering techniques to manipulate users into performing unsafe actions.

2. Objective

- Analyze phishing email samples
- Identify malicious indicators
- Understand social engineering tactics
- Compare phishing and legitimate emails
- Improve cybersecurity awareness

3. Tools & Techniques Used

- Email header inspection
- URL analysis
- Visual inspection
- Domain verification
- Cybersecurity awareness techniques
- Screenshot documentation
- GitHub documentation

4. Scope of Analysis

The assessment focused on analyzing phishing email samples involving banking fraud, fake login alerts, fake job opportunities, and reward scams. A legitimate Google security email was also analyzed for comparison purposes.

5. Methodology

- Reviewing sender domains
- Inspecting suspicious URLs
- Checking urgency language
- Identifying social engineering tactics
- Comparing phishing and legitimate emails
- Documenting findings

6. Phishing Indicators Overview

- Fake domains
- Urgent language
- Threat tactics

- Suspicious links
- Generic greetings
- Too-good-to-be-true offers
- Unverified attachments

7.1 Fake Bank Alert Email

Risk Level

High

Description

The email impersonates a banking institution and threatens account suspension.

Potential Impact

Users may unknowingly share banking credentials.

Why the Email is Suspicious

The email uses urgency and suspicious domains.

Recommendation

Users should verify banking notifications directly through official websites.

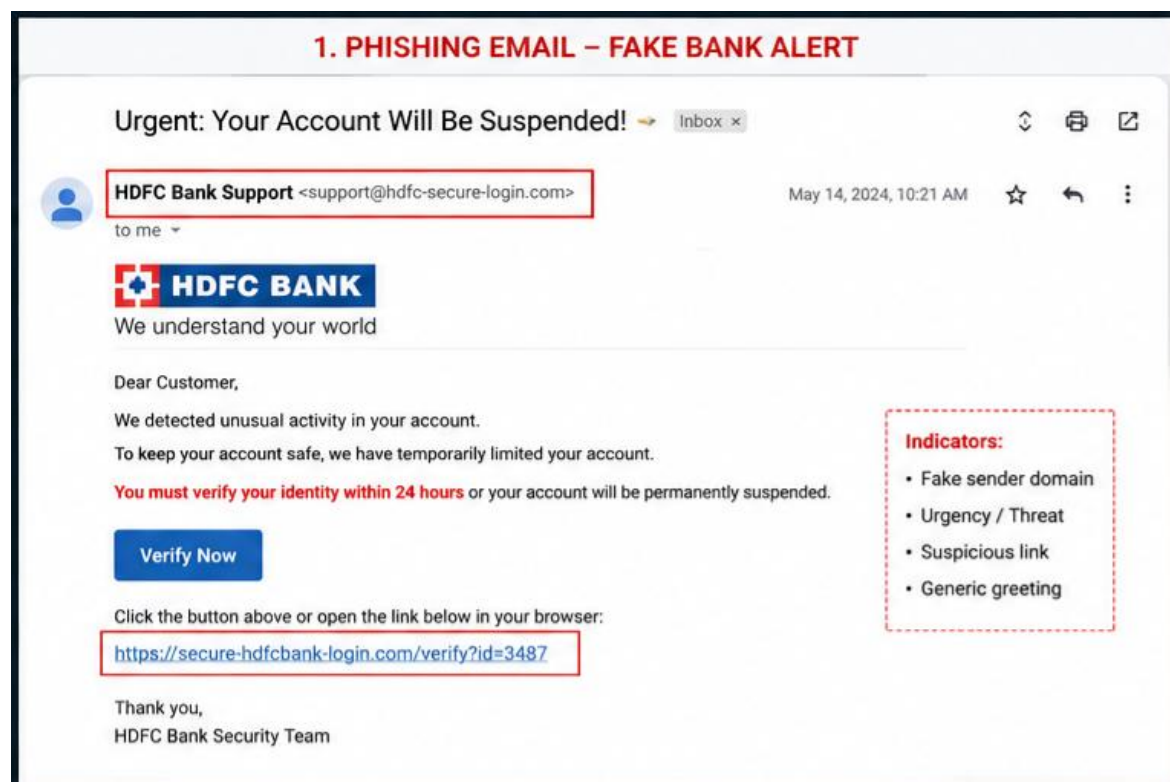


Figure 1: Fake bank phishing email containing malicious indicators.

7.2 Instagram Login Alert Phishing Email

Risk Level

High

Description

The email falsely claims suspicious Instagram login activity.

Potential Impact

Victims may lose access to their accounts.

Why the Email is Suspicious

The email contains suspicious login links and fake domains.

Recommendation

Users should verify login activity directly from Instagram.



Figure 2: Instagram phishing email attempting credential theft.

7.3 Fake Job Opportunity Scam Email

Risk Level

Medium

Description

The email promises a high-paying internship opportunity.

Potential Impact

Victims may disclose sensitive information.

Why the Email is Suspicious

The offer appears unrealistic and contains suspicious links.

Recommendation

Users should verify job opportunities before responding.

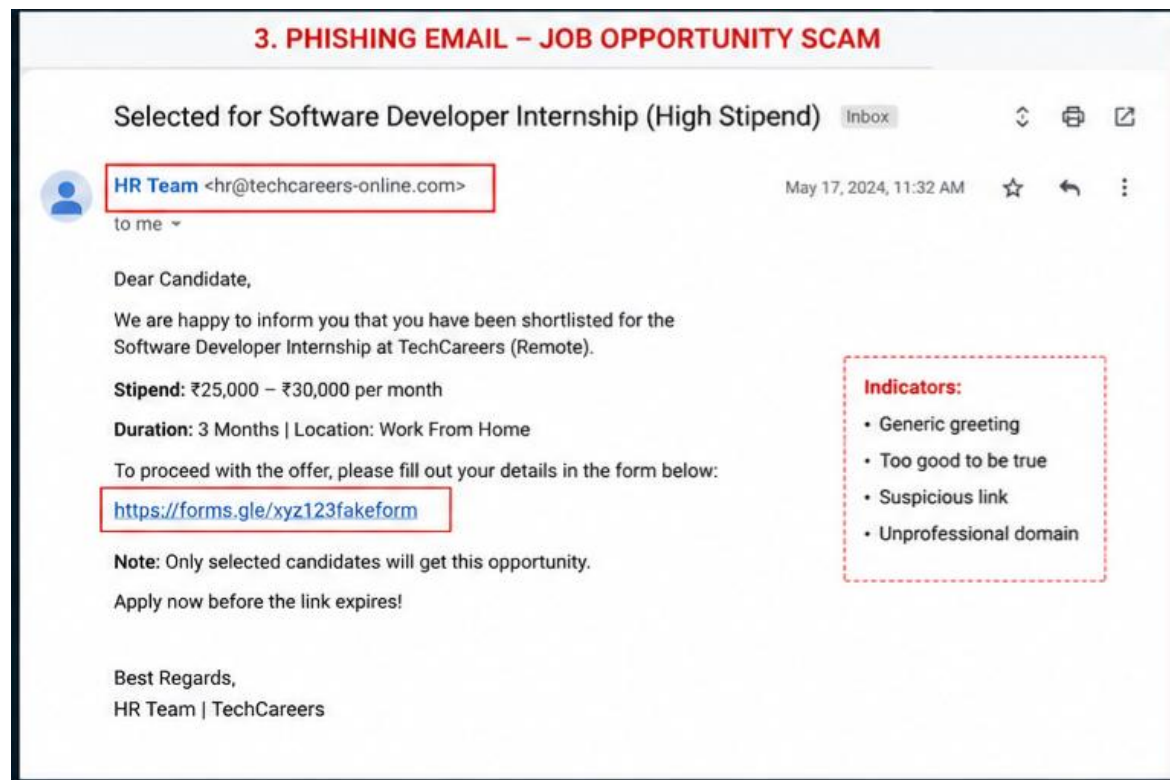


Figure 3: Fake job opportunity phishing email.

7.4 Fake Amazon Gift Card Scam Email

Risk Level

Medium

Description

The email claims the user has won a free Amazon gift card.

Potential Impact

Victims may be redirected to phishing websites.

Why the Email is Suspicious

The email uses fake rewards and urgency.

Recommendation

Users should avoid clicking unsolicited reward emails.

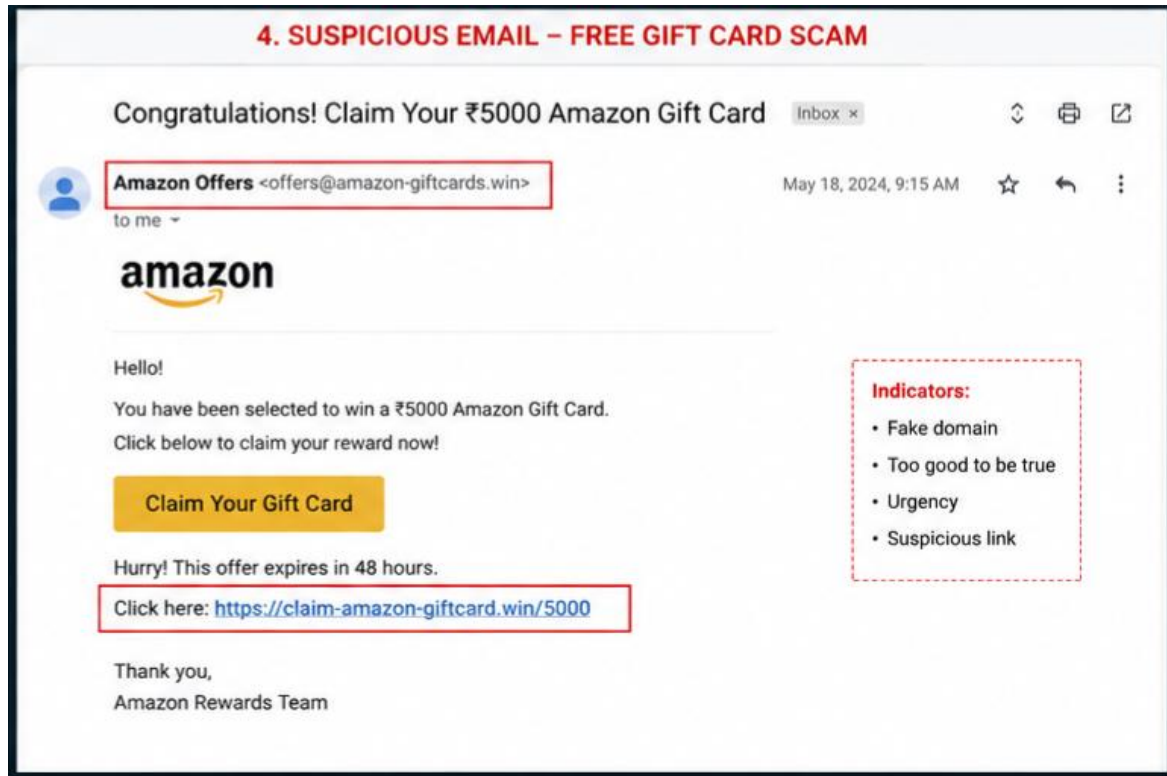


Figure 4: Amazon gift card phishing scam email.

7.5 Legitimate Email Comparison

Risk Level

Safe / Legitimate

Why the Email Appears Legitimate

- Trusted sender domain
- Professional branding
- No suspicious urgency
- Secure links
- Proper communication structure

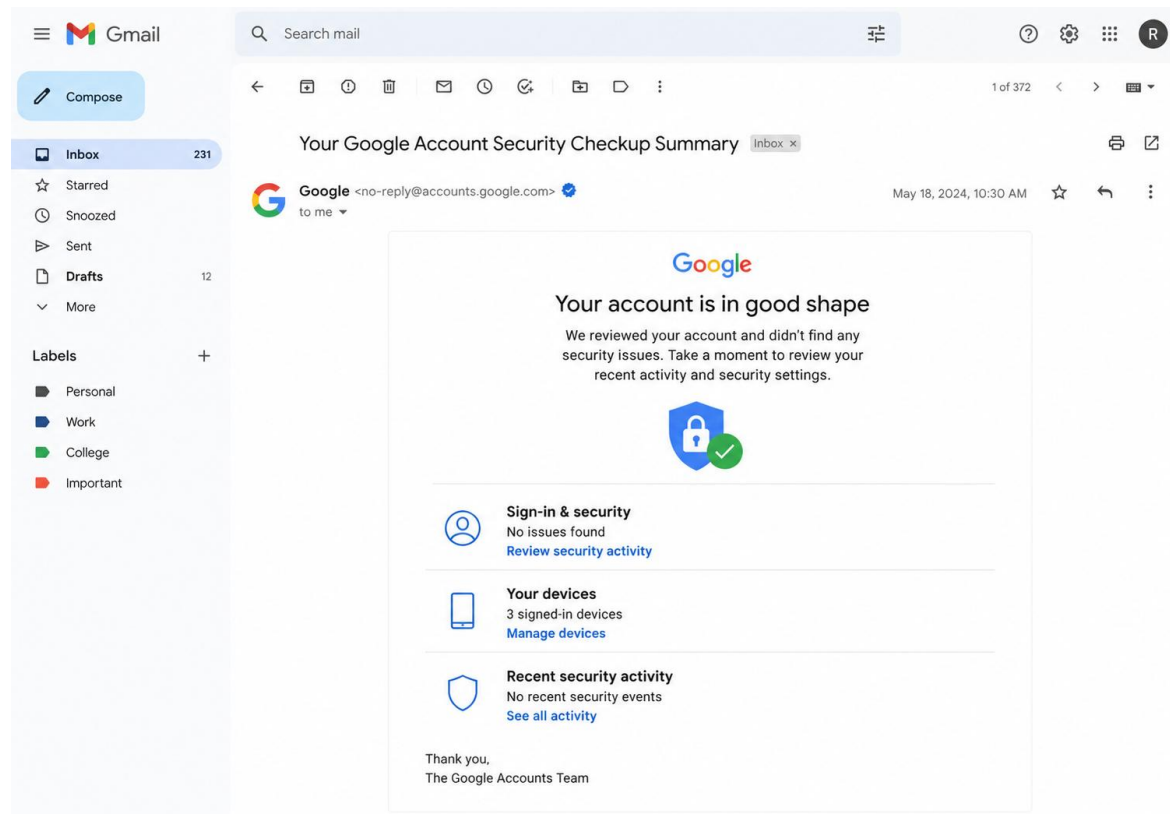


Figure 5: Legitimate Google security email example.

8. Findings Summary Table

Email Type	Risk Level	Key Indicators	Status
Fake Bank Alert	High	Fake domain, urgency	Phishing
Instagram Login Alert	High	Suspicious login link	Phishing
Job Opportunity Scam	Medium	Fake offer	Phishing
Amazon Gift Card Scam	Medium	Reward scam	Phishing
Google Security Email	Safe	Trusted sender	Legitimate

9. Awareness & Prevention Tips

- Never click suspicious links
- Verify sender domains
- Avoid emotional manipulation
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication
- Use spam filters
- Report phishing emails
- Verify attachments before opening

10. Conclusion

The phishing email analysis task provided practical exposure to identifying phishing indicators, understanding social engineering tactics, and differentiating between phishing and legitimate communications.

The assessment highlighted the importance of cybersecurity awareness, email verification, and safe online practices in reducing phishing-related risks.